ham badkismat, chakki mein pise jaa rahe hain (We, the unfortunate ones, are like grain that is being ground in a mill).' Therefore, the security forces must reassure the people that, unlike the terrorists, they are responsible and accountable for all their actions. No counterinsurgency strategy can succeed without the active support of the people who, in our case, happen to be citizens of our nation. Special efforts should be made to identify the opinion makers and to convince them that our 'cause' and their 'aspirations' coincide. It should be unambiguously conveyed to the people that our actions are essentially focused upon achieving peace and prosperity and their well-being.

The Indian Army evolved and promulgated a doctrine of sub-conventional operations/low-intensity conflict during my tenure as the chief of army staff. This is based on lessons learnt from decades of counterinsurgency and counterterrorism operations. A basic tenet of this doctrine advocated by me is the concept of 'an iron fist and a velvet glove'. This was widely covered during 2005 by our national media based on my interactions with them. *The Times of India* called it my pet theme. The 'iron fist' denotes a ruthless and 'no-nonsense' approach while tackling the insurgents or terrorists, and the 'velvet glove' demonstrates the compassion and humane face of the security forces while dealing with innocent citizens. This concept hinges on the fundamental principle of employing armed forces to enhance the effectiveness of the government machinery, while painstakingly avoiding the alienation of the masses. While countering insurgency, the army's role is to provide security to the population and a secure environment for the administration to be able to provide good governance. Only then can the development of remote and inaccessible areas of such disturbed regions take place and the other grievances of the people addressed. This concept lays emphasis on 'people-friendly' operations, upholding of the laws of the land, and an abiding respect for human rights. It has to be understood that 'wanton killing of innocent civilians is terrorism, not a war against terrorism', as stated by Noam Chomsky. Every soldier operating in a counterinsurgency campaign or fighting terror carries the army chief's commandments in his breast pocket. Ten commandments of